

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION — PRACTICE EXAMINATION**CLASS IX • SOCIAL SCIENCE (SUBJECT CODE: 087) • ACADEMIC SESSION 2026-27****SET A — FOUNDATION & CORE CONCEPTS****CHAPTER 04: EARLY HUMANS AND BEGINNING OF CIVILISATION**

TIME ALLOWED: 45 MINUTES

MAXIMUM MARKS: 25 MARKS

SERIES: CBS-IX-SST-SET-A-04

Student's Name: _____

Roll No.: _____

Class & Section: Class IX - _____

Date of Exam: _____

Invigilator's Sign: _____

General Instructions (SET A - Foundation & Core Concepts):

1. The question paper comprises **25 Multiple Choice Questions** of **1 mark each**.
2. All questions are compulsory. There is no negative marking for incorrect answers.
3. Each question offers four options: **(A), (B), (C), and (D)**. Select the single best answer.
4. Darken the corresponding circle on the **OMR Sheet** completely using a blue/black ballpoint pen.

Q.1 The earliest phase of human prehistory, characterized by rough chipped stone tools and a hunting-gathering lifestyle, is called the:

- (A) Palaeolithic Age (Old Stone Age) (B) Neolithic Age
(C) Chalcolithic Age (D) Iron Age

Q.2 The major revolutionary development that distinguished the Neolithic Age (New Stone Age) from earlier stone age periods was:

- (A) The beginning of agriculture, animal domestication, and settled village life (B) The invention of the steam locomotive
(C) The mass production of plastic tools (D) The exclusive reliance on hunting mammoths

Q.3 Small, sharp, delicately flaked stone tools typical of the Mesolithic (Middle Stone Age) period, often hafted onto bone or wooden handles, are termed:

- (A) Microliths (B) Hand axes
(C) Iron swords (D) Terracotta figurines

Q.4 The famous pre-historic rock-shelter cave paintings in India depicting animals, hunting scenes, and community dances are located at:

- (A) Bhimbetka (Madhya Pradesh) (B) Hampi (Karnataka)
(C) Ajanta (Maharashtra) (D) Konark (Odisha)

Q.5 The Harappan Civilisation (Indus Valley Civilisation) is chronologically classified as belonging to which major archaeological metallurgical age?

- (A) Bronze Age (B) Iron Age
(C) Palaeolithic Age (D) Atomic Age

Q.6 Which was the first excavated site of the Indus Valley Civilisation, discovered in 1921 under the direction of Daya Ram Sahni?

- | | |
|-------------|------------------|
| (A) Harappa | (B) Mohenjo-daro |
| (C) Lothal | (D) Kalibangan |

Q.7 Mohenjo-daro, excavated in 1922 by Rakhaldas Banerjee, literally translates in the Sindhi language to:

- | | |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|
| (A) Mound of the Dead | (B) City of Golden Temples |
| (C) The Great Market | (D) Fortress of Kings |

Q.8 The distinctive urban layout of Harappan cities was characterized by a division into two parts: an elevated western section called the:

- | | |
|--------------------------|----------------|
| (A) Citadel (Upper Town) | (B) Lower Town |
| (C) Agri-suburb | (D) Necropolis |

Q.9 What engineering pattern was followed by the residential streets and lanes in Harappan cities?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) Grid pattern intersecting at approximate right angles (90 degrees) | (B) Completely random and winding irregular dirt paths |
| (C) Concentric circular pathways without any exits | (D) Single straight tunnel without intersections |

Q.10 The monumental public water reservoir made of water-tight baked bricks lined with natural bitumen/tar discovered at Mohenjo-daro is known as the:

- | | |
|--------------------|---------------------------|
| (A) Great Bath | (B) Stepwell of Dholavira |
| (C) Royal Dockyard | (D) Granary of Harappa |

Q.11 Which Harappan coastal port city in Gujarat featured an engineered tidal brick dockyard connected to the Sabarmati river channel?

- | | |
|--------------|----------------|
| (A) Lothal | (B) Kalibangan |
| (C) Banawali | (D) Rakhigarhi |

Q.12 The Harappan site in Gujarat noted for its unique division into three distinct parts (Citadel, Middle Town, Lower Town) and elaborate stone water reservoirs is:

- | | |
|----------------|------------------|
| (A) Dholavira | (B) Harappa |
| (C) Kalibangan | (D) Sutkagen Dor |

Q.13 At which Harappan site were fired clay ploughed field furrows and sacrificial fire altars discovered?

- | | |
|----------------------------|------------------|
| (A) Kalibangan (Rajasthan) | (B) Mohenjo-daro |
| (C) Lothal | (D) Chanhudaro |

Q.14 What type of building bricks were universally used in Harappan construction that gave their structures exceptional durability?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Standardized sun-dried and kiln-fired (burnt) bricks with a 1:2:4 ratio | (B) Unshaped river mud mixed with straw only |
| (C) Roughly cut unmortared granite boulders | (D) Hollow timber logs |

Q.15 Which public health and civic amenity in Harappan cities was far ahead of any other contemporary Bronze Age civilisation?

- | | |
|--|---|
| (A) Underground, covered drainage systems with inspection manholes | (B) High-speed passenger railway tracks |
| (C) Large stone colosseums for gladiator games | (D) Electric street lighting poles |

Q.16 What soft stone was most commonly used by Harappan craftsmen to carve their famous rectangular seals depicting animal motifs?

- | | |
|--------------------------|--------------|
| (A) Steatite (Soapstone) | (B) Marble |
| (C) Diamond | (D) Obsidian |

Q.17 The famous bronze figurine found at Mohenjo-daro showing an expressive standing posture with one hand on her hip is known as the:

- | | |
|------------------|--------------------|
| (A) Dancing Girl | (B) Mother Goddess |
| (C) Priest-King | (D) Pashupati seal |

Q.18 Which mythical or real animal is most frequently depicted on Harappan seals?

- | | |
|--------------------------------|------------------------|
| (A) Unicorn (one-horned beast) | (B) Humped Bull (Zebu) |
| (C) Elephant | (D) Tiger |

Q.19 The script of the Indus Valley Civilisation has which of the following characteristics?

- | | |
|--|--|
| (A) It is pictographic/logosyllabic and remains undeciphered to date | (B) It was written in modern Devanagari script |
| (C) It uses the Roman alphabet of 26 letters | (D) It was fully translated into English in 1850 |

Q.20 Mesopotamian cuneiform tablets refer to the Harappan region and Indus trade by which name?

- | | |
|-------------|-----------|
| (A) Meluhha | (B) Magan |
| (C) Dilmun | (D) Sumer |

Q.21 What system of weights was predominantly used by Harappan merchants for trade and commercial transactions?

- | | |
|---|--|
| (A) Binary system in smaller denominations (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, 32...) and decimal system in higher ones, made of chert | (B) Random unmeasured stones without standards |
| (C) British Imperial pounds and ounces | (D) Gold coins with royal stamps |

Q.22 At which Harappan site was a massive stone sign-board with ten large Indus script characters discovered in the gateway?

- | | |
|------------------|-------------|
| (A) Dholavira | (B) Harappa |
| (C) Mohenjo-daro | (D) Ropar |

Q.23 Which precious blue mineral was imported by the Harappans from Shortughai in Badakhshan (Afghanistan)?

- | | |
|------------------|---------------|
| (A) Lapis Lazuli | (B) Carnelian |
| (C) Jade | (D) Amethyst |

Q.24 Which metal was notably UNKNOWN to the people of the Harappan Civilisation?

- (A) Iron (B) Copper
(C) Bronze (D) Gold

Q.25 Which of the following is considered a plausible factor contributing to the decline of the mature Harappan urban civilization around 1900 BCE?

- (A) Climate change, drying up of rivers (e.g., Saraswati/Ghaggar), deforestation, and shifting trade routes
(B) Invention of digital computers
(C) A sudden meteor impact that vaporized all cities instantaneously
(D) Voluntary migration of the entire population to Antarctica

CBSE CANDIDATE OMR ANSWER RESPONSE GRID (SET A)

01 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	02 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	03 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	04 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	05 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
06 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	07 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	08 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	09 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	10 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
11 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	12 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	13 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	14 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	15 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
16 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	17 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	18 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	19 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	20 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D
21 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	22 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	23 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	24 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D	25 ☐ A ☐ B ☐ C ☐ D

Total Questions Attempted: ____ / 25

Marks Obtained: ____ / 25

Evaluator's Signature: _____

OFFICIAL ANSWER KEY & STEP-BY-STEP EXPLANATIONS (SET A)

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.1	(A)	The Palaeolithic Age (spanning from over 2 million years ago to ~12,000 BCE) was characterized by nomadic hunter-gatherers using unpolished stone tools.
Q.2	(A)	The Neolithic Revolution marked the transition from foraging to food production (agriculture, cattle domestication, pottery, and permanent dwellings).
Q.3	(A)	Microliths are small geometric stone blades (1 to 5 cm long) characteristic of the Mesolithic transition, mounted as arrowheads or sickle teeth.
Q.4	(A)	Bhimbetka in Madhya Pradesh is a UNESCO World Heritage site renowned for its Mesolithic and Upper Palaeolithic rock art and cave dwellings.
Q.5	(A)	The Harappan Civilisation was a mature Bronze Age urban civilisation that alloyed copper with tin to produce bronze tools and ornaments.
Q.6	(A)	Harappa, located along the Ravi River (in modern Punjab, Pakistan), was excavated first in 1921, giving the civilisation its name.
Q.7	(A)	Mohenjo-daro translates to 'Mound of the Dead' in Sindhi and was one of the largest metropolitan centres of the Harappan civilization.
Q.8	(A)	Harappan settlements typically featured an elevated, fortified western section known as the Citadel, containing monumental public structures.
Q.9	(A)	Harappan town planning was based on an organized grid system where straight, wide streets intersected at approximate 90-degree right angles.
Q.10	(A)	The Great Bath at Mohenjo-daro is an iconic brick-built water-tight public bathing pool lined with gypsum mortar and natural bitumen.
Q.11	(A)	Lothal in Gujarat had a tidal dockyard, bead-making factories, and storehouses, serving as a primary maritime trading hub with Mesopotamia.
Q.12	(A)	Dholavira (in the Rann of Kutch) had a tripartite urban design and a sophisticated rainwater harvesting system of huge rock-cut reservoirs.
Q.13	(A)	Kalibangan in Rajasthan revealed evidence of ploughed agricultural fields and ritual brick fire altars.
Q.14	(A)	Harappans used standardized kiln-burnt bricks with uniform dimensions (thickness, width, and length in a 1:2:4 ratio) ensuring longevity.
Q.15	(A)	Harappan cities had covered brick drains with inspection sumps linking private house bathrooms to main street drains, showing advanced hygiene.
Q.16	(A)	Harappan seals were predominantly carved from steatite (soapstone), engraved with animal figures and script, and coated with a white glaze.
Q.17	(A)	The 'Dancing Girl' of Mohenjo-daro is an exquisite bronze masterpiece cast using the lost-wax (cire perdue) casting technique.
Q.18	(A)	The 'unicorn' motif (a single-horned mythical bovine creature) appears most frequently on Harappan seals, followed by the humped bull.
Q.19	(A)	Harappan script consists of roughly 400 pictographic signs written right-to-left, and despite extensive research, it remains undeciphered.

Q. No.	Correct	Curricular Reference & Conceptual Rationale
Q.20	(A)	Mesopotamian textual records refer to trade with 'Meluhha' (widely recognized by historians as the Indus Valley/Harappan region).
Q.21	(A)	Harappans had standard cubical chert weights following a binary system (1, 2, 4, 8, 16 up to 12,800) and decimal multiples for precision.
Q.22	(A)	Dholavira yielded a remarkable wooden inscription board embedded with 10 large white crystalline gypsum signs, often called the 'Dholavira Signboard'.
Q.23	(A)	The Harappan trading colony of Shortughai in northeastern Afghanistan was established to secure precious Lapis Lazuli gemstones.
Q.24	(A)	Harappans were a Bronze Age society and were unaware of iron metallurgy; the Iron Age in India began much later (~1000 BCE).
Q.25	(A)	Archaeological consensus points to multiple ecological factors: shifting river channels, prolonged aridity, deforestation, and collapse of regional trade networks.